

慶應義塾大学 経済学部 英語

自習プリント

英語が得意な人のための「私大難関本番レベル」— 不平等の経済学を読み解く

2026 年 5 月 26 日

高校 3 年～既卒 (難関私大文系志望)

英語 (慶應 経済学部・本番水準)

Trillion 塾

第1章 (例題 — 慶應 経済学部レベル・5 分)

慶應経済は 100 分・大問 6 題。本問は長文 1 題で 25-30 分相当 (経済学部の典型ブロック)。

【例題】(慶應義塾大学 経済学部 入試 典型形式・改題)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

For most of the twentieth century, economists in the major industrial democracies operated under what we might call the (A) Kuznets reassurance. Simon Kuznets, the Russian-born American economist who would later receive a Nobel Prize, had argued in the 1950s that economic inequality, while pronounced in the early stages of industrialization, would gradually diminish as economies matured. As workers acquired more education, as labour-saving technologies raised productivity, as universal suffrage made redistributive policy possible, the gap between the richest and the rest would close. Inequality, on this view, was a transitional phenomenon — a stage through which developing economies passed on their way to a more equal future.

For about three decades after the Second World War, the data appeared to confirm the prediction. In the United States, in Western Europe, in Japan, the share of national income received by the very richest tenth of households fell to historical lows, while the share received by the bottom half rose. Middle-class incomes grew at roughly the same pace as those at the top. The political economist Anthony Atkinson would later describe this period as "the great compression": a moment when the long historical pattern of extreme inequality appeared to have been definitively broken.

Then, beginning in the 1980s, the compression unwound. Across the same advanced economies that had earlier celebrated their move toward greater equality, the income share of the top one per cent began to rise sharply; in some countries it more than doubled within a generation. The recent shift was most dramatic in the United States, where by the 2010s the top tenth of households received approximately half of all national income, but the pattern was visible, in milder form, in nearly every wealthy democracy. The Kuznets reassurance had been, at minimum, premature.

The French economist Thomas Piketty offered the most influential diagnosis of the reversal. In his 2013 book **Capital in the Twenty-First Century**, he argued that the post-

war compression had been not a maturity effect but an exceptional consequence of war, depression, and the political settlements those crises had made possible. Under more ordinary circumstances, Piketty proposed, the rate of return on capital tends to exceed the rate of economic growth, with the result that wealth accumulates faster than wages and that already-wealthy households compound their advantage across generations. Inequality, on this view, was not a transitional symptom but a structural tendency of capitalist economies, held in check only by specific historical interruptions.

The Piketty thesis attracted both fervent admiration and rigorous criticism. Some economists argued that he had overstated the universality of his " r greater than g " relationship and had paid insufficient attention to the role of technology in producing skill-biased income gaps. Others welcomed his recovery of long-run historical data but disputed his policy prescriptions, particularly the proposal for a global tax on wealth. What few participants in the debate denied, however, was that the post-war assumption — that inequality was a problem solving itself — had not survived contact with the evidence of the past four decades.

The deeper significance of the reversal lies, perhaps, less in the precise figures than in the political and intellectual challenge it poses. A society that expects equality to arrive of its own accord will organize its institutions very differently from one that expects extreme inequality to be the default. The Kuznets reassurance had encouraged a kind of patience: redistributive policy could be modest because demographic and economic forces were already doing much of the work. The post-Piketty consensus, more cautious, takes seriously the possibility that without deliberate intervention the long historical pattern of severe inequality is what societies revert to.

Whether the public policies that would meaningfully change the trajectory — substantial wealth taxation, expanded provision of public goods, structural reform of labour markets — are politically achievable in any major democracy is, of course, a separate question. What the past four decades have settled is the more modest but crucial point that they are needed: that the inequality of advanced economies is no longer, if it ever was, a problem expected to solve itself.

Q1. What is the "Kuznets reassurance" described in the first paragraph?

- ① The belief that economic inequality would automatically diminish as economies matured.
- ② The belief that inequality would worsen indefinitely under capitalism.
- ③ The belief that Russian-born economists are most reliable.
- ④ The belief that economic data should always be kept secret.

Q2. What did the post-war "great compression" refer to, according to the second paragraph?

- ① A reduction in the physical size of national economies.
- ② A historical period when income inequality in advanced democracies reached historical lows and middle-class incomes grew alongside top incomes.
- ③ A government policy that restricted international trade.
- ④ The increase in income inequality observed in developing countries.

Q3. According to Thomas Piketty's diagnosis, why did the post-war compression unwind?

- ① Because workers stopped acquiring more education.
- ② Because the post-war compression had been an exceptional consequence of war and depression, while under ordinary circumstances the rate of return on capital exceeds the rate of economic growth.
- ③ Because universal suffrage was abolished in the 1980s.
- ④ Because technology stopped advancing in wealthy democracies.

Q4. Which of the following is NOT cited as a criticism that some economists raised against Piketty's thesis?

- ① That he had overstated the universality of his " r greater than g " relationship.
- ② That he had paid insufficient attention to the role of technology in producing skill-biased income gaps.
- ③ That his proposal for a global tax on wealth was politically difficult.
- ④ That his use of long-run historical data was entirely fabricated.

Q5. Why does the author argue that the deeper significance of the inequality reversal "lies less in the precise figures" than in something else?

- ① Because the figures themselves have been disputed by all economists.
- ② Because a society's expectation about whether equality arrives automatically shapes how it organizes its redistributive institutions.

- ③ Because mathematical analysis is irrelevant to economics.
- ④ Because the figures will soon be replaced by new ones.

Q6. Which of the following best summarizes the author's overall conclusion?

- ① The Kuznets reassurance has been definitively confirmed by the past four decades.
- ② Inequality in advanced economies is no longer expected to solve itself; deliberate policy intervention is needed, although whether such policies are politically achievable remains a separate question.
- ③ All forms of taxation should be abolished immediately.
- ④ Inequality has no real effect on political institutions or policy.

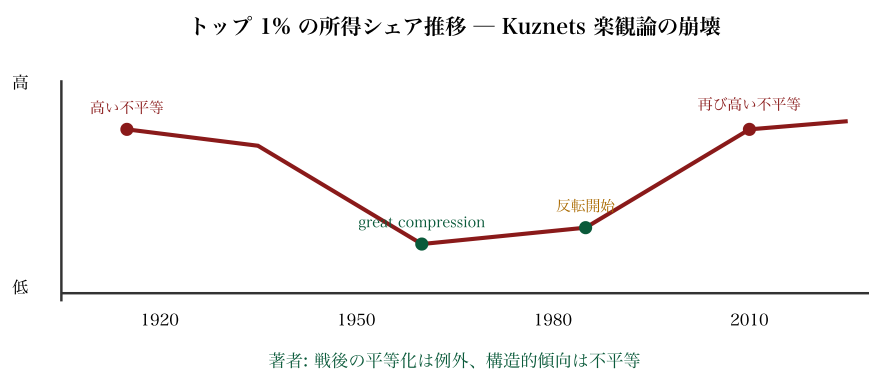


図 1-1 U 字曲線 — 戦後の compression は exceptional、Piketty 説で再解釈

第2章 (解法の全体方針と武器整理・3 分)

経済エッセイは「通念 → 実証 → 反証 → 新理論 → 批判 → 含意 → 政策的結論」の 7 段論法。

【ジャンル分析】

本文は典型的な (A) economic-history essay。著者は 7 段かけて、Kuznets 説 (楽観) から Piketty 説 (構造的不平等) への paradigm shift を描く。(B) 慶應経済の長文は実証データと理論モデルが交差する論文型が頻出。

【本問で必要な 4 つの武器】

- ① (A) 時系列の所得分布 を追う (1920s → 1950-70s great compression → 1980s 反転)
- ② (B) 理論モデルの paraphrase — " r greater than g " の論理を Japanese で言語化できるか
- ③ (C) 経済学者の系譜 を捕捉 (Kuznets → Atkinson → Piketty)
- ④ (D) 著者の立場 = post-Piketty consensus の慎重な擁護者 と読む

【各設問の戦略】

Q1 (Kuznets 説) → 第 1 段 "automatically diminish ... matured"

Q2 (great compression) → 第 2 段 "historical lows ... middle-class incomes grew"

Q3 (Piketty 説) → 第 4 段 "rate of return on capital exceeds the rate of economic growth"

Q4 (NOT 設問) → 第 5 段の批判リストから除外要素を消去法で

Q5 (修辞設問・図と現実) → 第 6 段 "expectations ... organize institutions very differently"

Q6 (全体結論) → 最終段 "no longer ... a problem expected to solve itself"

第3章 (Q1 — Kuznets 説定義・3 分)

経済 Q1 は「核心概念の定義」を聞く。第 1 段で即決。

【設問】 What is the "Kuznets reassurance" described in the first paragraph?

★ Step 1: 第 1 段の Kuznets 論を抽出

"Simon Kuznets ... had argued in the 1950s that (A) economic inequality, while pronounced in the early stages of industrialization, would gradually diminish as economies matured."

具体的メカニズム: 教育拡大 / 生産性向上 / 普通選挙による再分配政策

結論: "Inequality ... was a (B) transitional phenomenon — a stage through which developing economies passed on their way to a more equal future."

★ Step 2: paraphrase 対応

本文 "would gradually diminish as economies matured"

選択肢① "would automatically diminish as economies matured"

→ "gradually" → "automatically" は本文の含意 (経済の成熟に任せれば自然に減る) を要約。

★ Step 3: 誤答分析

- ・ ② "worsen indefinitely" → 本文と (A) 逆方向。
- ・ ③ "Russian-born economists are most reliable" → (B) 無関係。Kuznets の出身は背景情報のみ。
- ・ ④ "economic data should always be kept secret" → (C) 論点ずれ。

【正解】 ① The belief that economic inequality would automatically diminish as economies matured.

第4章 (Q2 + Q3 — Great Compression + Piketty 説・10 分)

「実証データ → 新理論」の連動を読む。

【Q2 設問】 What did the post-war "great compression" refer to?

★ 該当段 (第 2 段)

"the share of national income received by the very richest tenth of households fell to historical lows, while the share received by the bottom half rose. Middle-class incomes grew at roughly the same pace as those at the top. The political economist Anthony Atkinson would later describe this period as '(A) the great compression': a moment when the long historical pattern of extreme inequality appeared to have been definitively broken."

★ Q2 の paraphrase 対応

本文 "income inequality reached historical lows ... middle-class incomes grew at roughly the same pace as those at the top"

選択肢② "income inequality in advanced democracies reached historical lows and middle-class incomes grew alongside top incomes"

→ 直接対応。

【Q2 正解】 ② A historical period when income inequality in advanced democracies reached historical lows and middle-class incomes grew alongside top incomes.

【Q3 設問】 According to Piketty, why did the compression unwind?

★ 該当段 (第 4 段) の論理

"the post-war compression had been not a maturity effect but (A) an exceptional consequence of war, depression, and the political settlements those crises had made possible. Under more ordinary circumstances, Piketty proposed, (B) the rate of return on capital tends to exceed the rate of economic growth, with the result that wealth accumulates faster than wages and that already-wealthy households compound their advantage across generations."

→ Piketty 説の核心: (i) 戦後の平等化は exceptional (ii) 通常時は資本収益率 > 経済成長率 = "r > g" (iii) 結果として富が世代を超えて蓄積。

★ Q3 の paraphrase 対応

本文 "exceptional consequence of war, depression ... rate of return on capital tends to exceed the rate of economic growth"

選択肢② "exceptional consequence of war and depression ... rate of return on capital exceeds the rate of economic growth"

→ 完全一致。

【Q3 正解】② Because the post-war compression had been an exceptional consequence of war and depression, while under ordinary circumstances the rate of return on capital exceeds the rate of economic growth.

★ 重要観察 — Q2 と Q3 の連動

Q2 = 実証データの記述 (compression が起きた) → Q3 = 新理論による解釈 (なぜ起きたか、なぜ反転したか)。 (A) データ → 理論 の連動は経済学エッセイの基本骨格。

第5章 (Q4 — NOT 設問・Piketty 批判・5 分)

経済頻出 NOT 設問。第 5 段の批判リストを順に消去。

【設問】 Which of the following is NOT cited as a criticism that some economists raised against Piketty's thesis?

★ Step 1: 第 5 段の批判を抽出

"Some economists argued that he had (A) overstated the universality of his 'r greater than g' relationship and had (B) paid insufficient attention to the role of technology in producing skill-biased income gaps. Others welcomed his recovery of long-run historical data but (C) disputed his policy prescriptions, particularly the proposal for a global tax on wealth."

★ Step 2: 選択肢と照合

- ・ ① "overstated the universality of 'r greater than g'" → 根拠 (A) 下線A : ○
- ・ ② "insufficient attention to technology / skill-biased income" → 根拠 (B) 下線A : ○
- ・ ③ "global tax on wealth ... politically difficult" → 根拠 (C) に近い 下線A : ○
- ・ ④ "use of long-run historical data was entirely fabricated" → (B) 本文と逆方向。本文 "welcomed his recovery of long-run historical data" と明示。

【正解】 ④ That his use of long-run historical data was entirely fabricated.

💡 経済 NOT 設問では「データの捏造」「方法論的不正」のような(A) 学術的不誠実を示唆する選択肢が罠。本文は Piketty の批判者ですら data 自体は評価していると明示。

第6章 (Q5 — Why does the author argue 設問・5 分)

「期待が制度を形成する」という政治経済学的含意を読む。

【設問】 Why does the author argue that the deeper significance lies "less in the precise figures"?

★ Step 1: 第 6 段の論理

"The deeper significance of the reversal lies, perhaps, less in the precise figures than in (A) the political and intellectual challenge it poses. A society that expects equality to arrive of its own accord will (B) organize its institutions very differently from one that expects extreme inequality to be the default."

具体的対比:

- ・ Kuznets 仮定 → 「再分配政策は控えめでよい (経済が勝手にやる)」
- ・ post-Piketty 仮定 → 「deliberate intervention なしには extreme inequality に戻る」

★ Step 2: paraphrase 対応

本文 "A society that expects equality to arrive of its own accord will organize its institutions very differently"

選択肢② "a society's expectation about whether equality arrives automatically shapes how it organizes its redistributive institutions"

→ "expects ... arrive of its own accord" → "expectation about whether equality arrives automatically"、"organize its institutions" 直接一致。

【正解】 ② Because a society's expectation about whether equality arrives automatically shapes how it organizes its redistributive institutions.

💡 政治経済学的観点: データ自体ではなく「データへの期待」が制度設計を変える、という meta-argumentation. "figures are settled; expectations are not" がエッセイの核心。

第7章 (Q6 — Main Idea 設問 + 関連話題・10 分)

経済エッセイの結論は「実証 + 政策の必要性 + 政治的限界の認識」型。

【設問】 Which of the following best summarizes the author's overall conclusion?

★ Step 1: 最終段を精読

"Whether the public policies that would meaningfully change the trajectory — substantial wealth taxation, expanded provision of public goods, structural reform of labour markets — are politically achievable in any major democracy is, of course, (A) a separate question. What the past four decades have settled is the more modest but crucial point that (B) they are needed: that the inequality of advanced economies is no longer, if it ever was, a problem expected to solve itself."

→ 主旨 3 要素:

- ①不平等は自動的に解決しない (実証された)
- ②政策介入が必要 (規範的結論)
- ③政治的実現可能性は別問題 (慎重な留保)

★ Step 2: 選択肢②との対応

"Inequality in advanced economies is no longer expected to solve itself; deliberate policy intervention is needed, although whether such policies are politically achievable remains a separate question."

→ 3 要素すべて含む。

【Q6 正解】 ② Inequality in advanced economies is no longer expected to solve itself; deliberate policy intervention is needed, although whether such policies are politically achievable remains a separate question.

★ 関連話題 — 慶應経済進学後への接続

- ・ (A) Simon Kuznets (1901-1985) ノーベル賞 1971 — GDP 統計の創始者、Kuznets curve 提唱
- ・ (B) Thomas Piketty — 21 世紀の不平等経済学を牽引、World Inequality Database を主宰
- ・ (C) Anthony Atkinson (1944-2017) — 不平等経済学の英国側の巨人、Atkinson index
- ・ (D) Joseph Stiglitz — Price of Inequality、ノーベル賞 2001
- ・ (A) Daron Acemoglu — Why Nations Fail、制度と長期成長

★ 大学進学後への接続

1 年次: 経済学原理・統計学・ミクロ/マクロ経済学

2-3 年次: 公共経済学ゼミ / 経済発展論ゼミ / 計量経済学

卒論候補: 日本の所得分布の長期動態 / 戦後日本の compression 期の分析 / Wealth tax の国際比較

第8章 (経済学部英語 攻略のコツ・5 分)

慶應経済長文を完答するための 5 つの技術。

【コツ 1】 7 段論法 (通念 → 実証 → 反証 → 新理論 → 批判 → 含意 → 政策結論) を予測

経済エッセイは「データ ↔ 理論」の往復で進む。各段がデータ提示なのか理論提示なのかをマーキング。

【コツ 2】 経済学者の固有名詞リストを覚える

- ・ (A) Kuznets / Solow / Friedman / Samuelson — 20 世紀の巨人
- ・ (B) Piketty / Atkinson / Stiglitz / Acemoglu — 21 世紀の現役
- ・ (C) Sen / Krugman / Kahneman — ノーベル賞経済学者
- ・ 受験英語では Kuznets curve, $r > g$, GDP, Gini coefficient 等の用語が頻出

【コツ 3】 経済頻出語の文脈推測

compression / reassurance / share / quintile / decile / redistribution / suffrage / structural / trajectory / prescriptions

【コツ 4】 誤答パターン 4 種 (経済版)

- ・ (A) 学術的不誠実示唆: fabricated / falsified / discredited — 真面目な経済論争では使われない
- ・ (B) 極端化: definitively / abolished / no real effect / always
- ・ (C) 論点ずれ: 国家秘密 / 経済学者の出身国 / 経済学の有用性そのもの
- ・ (D) 逆方向: 著者の主張と反対 (Kuznets を肯定する選択肢など)

【コツ 5】 時間配分 (慶應経済 100 分)

大問構成が多い (5-6 題) ので、長文には (A) 25-30 分 を上限とする。複数長文の場合は配分注意。

【最後にひとこと】

慶應経済の英語は (A) 語学試験 であると同時に (B) 経済学リテラシー試験。本問のような不平等論は、入学後に学ぶ公共経済学・経済発展論の核心テーマ。Piketty のような名前を本番で見たら「あ、知ってる」となる準備を。

第9章 (類題チャレンジ・10 分) [10 点]

本講義の手法を応用する 5 問。

(類題 1) 本文中の "transitional phenomenon" の意味として最も近いものを選びなさい。

- ① 発展途上の一時的な段階で、いずれ消える現象
- ② 永続的に存在し続ける現象
- ③ 突然出現した革命的現象
- ④ 数学的に証明された現象

(類題 2) 本文の " r greater than g " が示すものとして最も適切なものを選びなさい。

- ① 資本収益率が経済成長率を上回ること (Piketty の中核命題)
- ② 輸出が輸入を上回ること
- ③ 実質賃金が物価上昇を上回ること
- ④ 政府支出が税収を上回ること

(類題 3) 本文中で Anthony Atkinson が引用される目的として最も適切なものを選びなさい。

- ① 戦後の所得平等化を「great compression」と命名した政治経済学者として
- ② Piketty の主たる批判者として
- ③ Kuznets の指導教官として
- ④ global wealth tax の発案者として

(類題 4) 本文の "skill-biased income gaps" が示唆するものとして最も適切なものを選びなさい。

- ① 技能水準の高い労働者と低い労働者の所得格差が技術進歩で拡大する現象
- ② 性別による所得差
- ③ 国家間の経済格差
- ④ 都市と地方の格差

(類題 5) 本文の論理構成として最も近いものを選びなさい。

- ① Kuznets 楽観論 → 戦後 compression データ → 1980 年代の反転 → Piketty 構造説
→ 批判 → 政治制度への含意 → 政策必要性
- ② 結論先出し → 根拠列挙のみ
- ③ 賛成意見の単純な列挙
- ④ 歴史的説明のみで結論なし

第10章 (まとめ・宿題・5 分)

今日の核心整理と慶應経済本番に向けた宿題

【本日の核心 5 か条】

- ① 経済エッセイは (A) 「データ ↔ 理論」の 7 段論法。各段でデータか理論かを識別。
- ② (B) $r > g$ (資本収益率 > 経済成長率) は Piketty の核心命題。受験英語頻出。
- ③ (C) Kuznets curve / great compression 等の経済史用語を文脈推測で。
- ④ NOT 設問は「(D) 学術的不誠実を示唆する選択肢」(fabricated 等) が罣。
- ⑤ 主旨設問は(A) 実証 + 政策必要性 + 政治的限界の認識の 3 点セットを選ぶ。

【宿題】

- ① 本講義の Q1-Q6 を見ないで本文だけ読み直し、自分で 6 問の設問を作成。
- ② 類題 5 問を解き直し、本文 7 段の各段にひと言タイトルを書き出す。
- ③ 過去問: 慶應義塾大学 経済学部 英語 (過去 5 年分) から長文 1 題を選び、本日の手法で精読する。

【次回授業】 慶應経済の英作文 (300 words 程度) — "Should the government implement a wealth tax to reduce inequality?" の論理構成

【最後にひとこと】

慶應経済の英語は(A) 語学試験であると同時に(B) 経済学リテラシー試験。本問の不平等論は、入学後に学ぶ公共経済学・経済発展論の予告編。